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# Data Maturity Framework Comparative Analysis

# Data Maturity Framework Comparative Analysis: Framework Selection for Rackspace Technology

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A comparative analysis of seven data and analytics maturity frameworks sourced from the Carnegie Mellon University CDAIO Program Module 3 (Douglas Laney) and the Data Culture coaching framework (Coach Karan), prepared by Team Agnoli as a deliverable for the Carnegie Mellon University Chief Data & AI Officer Executive Program. Each framework is modeled across its dimensions, strengths, and limitations, then evaluated against weighted criteria specific to Rackspace Technology's organizational profile, strategic priorities, and AI-first transformation posture. The analysis concludes with a primary and complementary framework recommendation along with a phased deployment approach.

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# 1 The Frameworks Inventoried

The source materials surface seven distinct frameworks, and they fall into two categories that are worth separating before conducting any comparative analysis, because the distinction matters enormously for Rackspace.

**Category A: Data Management & Capability Maturity Models** assess the technical and process infrastructure of how an organization manages data assets.

**Category B: Data Culture & Leadership Models** assess the human, organizational, and behavioral dimensions of becoming data-driven.

## 1.1 Category A: Data Management Maturity

### 1.1.1 DAMA DMBOK2

**Dimensions.** 11 dimensions covering Data Governance, Data Architecture, Data Modeling & Design, Data Storage & Operations, Data Security, Data Integration & Interoperability, Document & Content Management, Reference & Master Data, Data Warehousing & Business Intelligence, Metadata Management, and Data Quality.

**Strengths.** Adaptable, widely adopted, and comprehensive. Includes inputs, activities, and deliverables for each dimension.

**Limitations.** No shared benchmarking data. Resource intensive to deploy. Limited guidance on how to apply it. No AI or data value/utility coverage. Functions as the encyclopedia of data management: exhaustive on what data management *is*, silent on what data management *produces*.

### 1.1.2 EDMC DCAM

**Dimensions.** 8 dimensions spanning Data Management Strategy & Business Case, Data Management Program & Funding Model, Business & Data Architecture, Data & Technology Architecture, Data Quality Management, Data Governance, Data Control Environment, and Analytics Management.

**Strengths.** A capability model (not maturity model), modular in structure with 38 required capabilities and 136 sub-capabilities. Carries global benchmark data. Financial-services industry standard with broad adoption.

**Limitations.** Requires certified assessors. Heavy regulatory and financial-sector focus. No AI or data usage-related coverage.

### 1.1.3 TDWI Data Management Maturity Model

**Dimensions.** 5 dimensions: Organization, Resources, Architecture, Data Life Cycle, and Governance.

**Strengths.** Freely available with 75 questions. Benchmarking by industry, region, and company size. Publishes aggregate findings and pairs assessments with best-practice recommendations. Offers separate related assessments for BI and AI maturity, data ecosystems, data governance, AI readiness, and data quality.

**Limitations.** The extensibility comes at a cost: you are assembling a multi-assessment patchwork rather than getting a unified view. No single integrated assessment covers the full data, analytics, AI, and culture spectrum.

### 1.1.4 Gartner D&A Maturity Score

**Dimensions.** 8 dimensions: Strategy & Operating Model, Organization, Outcomes, Function, AI Maturity, Analytics Content, Data Integration & Management, and Data & Analytics Governance.

**Strengths.** Executive-focused and strategy-oriented with peer comparisons and tracking. Sufficient granularity. The only Category A framework that explicitly includes AI maturity as a first-class dimension.

**Limitations.** Locked behind the Gartner paywall and designed for their advisory relationship model. Less comprehensive on the technical dimensions than other options.

### 1.1.5 CMMI Data Management Maturity Model

**Dimensions.** 5 dimensions: Strategy, Quality, Operations, Platform & Architecture, and Governance, spanning 25 process areas.

**Strengths.** Prescriptive with strict process alignment. Useful when the primary concern is standardizing operations.

**Limitations.** No benchmarking data. No focus on analytics, AI, or data value. The most process-rigid option, leaving the entire analytics, AI, and value realization conversation on the table.

## 1.2 Category B: Data Culture & Leadership Maturity

### 1.2.1 CDAMM (Comprehensive D&A Maturity Model — Douglas Laney)

**Dimensions.** 8 dimensions: Strategy & Approach, Culture & Leadership, Metrics & KPIs, Organization & Skills, Architecture & Integration, Governance & Quality, Deployment & Usage, and Technology & Operations. Each dimension is scored across 5 levels (Aware, Reactive, Proactive, Managed, Optimized) with over 200 distinct indicators.

**Secondary Attributes.** Also includes secondary cross-cutting attributes spanning Collaboration, Communication, Execution, External, Financial, Implementation, Innovation, Legal, Planning, Process, Quality, Support, and Value.

**Strengths.** Uniquely bridges both Category A and Category B. Covers technical infrastructure, culture, leadership, and value realization in a single integrated assessment. Self-assessment feasible without certified assessors. Can be scoped at enterprise, division, or department level. Supports juxtaposition analysis (knowledge workers vs. management, business vs. IT, business unit vs. business unit).

**Limitations.** Proprietary model with less publicly available benchmark data than TDWI or EDMC. Requires significant investment in assessment effort given the 200+ indicators.

### 1.2.2 VECTR Pillars Data Culture Assessment Framework (Coach Karan)

**Dimensions.** 5 pillars: Leadership Vision, Executive Ownership, Collaboration, Decision Traceability, and Value Realization. Each pillar has 4 competencies scored across 4 levels.

**Strengths.** Purpose-built for the cultural and behavioral dimensions of data maturity. Addresses data storytelling, gamification approaches, cross-functional partnerships, and decision intelligence. Freely deployable as a self-assessment. Deliberately fills the gap that traditional maturity models leave: measuring whether anyone actually *uses* data to make decisions and whether leadership truly champions data as a strategic asset.

**Limitations.** Does not assess technical capabilities, data architecture, or operational infrastructure. By design, it is a complement to a technical maturity model, not a standalone replacement.

# 2 Rackspace Technology: Organizational Profile

Before evaluating framework fit, the target organization must be understood in sufficient depth. The following profile is assembled entirely from public intelligence.

## 2.1 Company Fundamentals

Rackspace Technology is a publicly traded (NASDAQ: RXT) end-to-end hybrid multicloud technology services company with approximately $2.7 billion in annual revenue (declining roughly 2% year-over-year) and approximately 7,700 employees.

## 2.2 Strategic Posture

Rackspace is in the middle of a fundamental business model pivot — from managed hosting and infrastructure services toward AI-optimized platforms and AI-as-a-service. The FAIR practice (Foundry for AI by Rackspace) has identified over 500 use cases across industries. The March 2025 launch of Rackspace AI Business (a Dell/NVIDIA-powered private cloud platform for AI workloads) and the February 2026 Palantir partnership signal that data and AI are no longer supporting capabilities — they are becoming the product.

## 2.3 Key Characteristics Shaping Framework Selection

**Technology-Native but Internally Immature on Data**

Rackspace *sells* data and cloud services. That does not mean their internal data management, culture, and decision-making practices match what they sell externally. The cobbler's children problem is real here.

**AI Is the Bet**

83% of Rackspace's own survey respondents expect to increase AI investments. Only 13% qualify as AI Leaders. Rackspace is building for customers who face the same maturity gap internally.

**Talent Constraints Are Acute**

40% cite lack of skilled cloud professionals, 37% cite insufficient budgets. Key hiring gaps exist in machine learning (42%), data analytics, engineering, and governance (40%).

### Regulatory and Compliance Pressure

As a company handling customer data across multicloud environments, governance is not optional — it is the product differentiator.

### Revenue Under Pressure

A 2% year-over-year decline means this is not an academic exercise. The maturity assessment needs to connect directly to business value, revenue enablement, and transformation velocity.

### No Publicly Visible CDO

Rackspace publishes extensive thought leadership about CDO roles but there is no public evidence of a dedicated Chief Data Officer driving internal data strategy.

# 3 Evaluation Criteria — Weighted for Rackspace

Not all frameworks matter equally for every organization. The following criteria are weighted by strategic relevance specifically for Rackspace Technology.

TABLE 3.1: RACKSPACE-SPECIFIC EVALUATION CRITERIA

| Criterion | Weight | Why It Matters for Rackspace |
|---|---|---|
| AI/ML Coverage | 25% | AI is the core strategic pivot; a framework without AI dimensionality is incomplete by definition |
| Culture & Leadership Assessment | 20% | Rackspace is a tech company that needs culture change to operationalize its own data internally |
| Data Value/Monetization | 15% | Rackspace monetizes data services externally — framework must speak the language of data-as-product |
| Benchmarking Availability | 10% | Peer comparison against other tech/cloud companies accelerates executive buy-in |
| Self-Assessment Feasibility | 10% | No public CDO, no indication of large internal data office — needs to be deployable without certified assessors |
| Comprehensiveness | 10% | Must cover enough dimensions to give a meaningful picture without gaps |
| AI Governance & Compliance | 10% | Multicloud provider handling customer data needs governance to be explicit, not implied |

# 4 Framework Scoring Matrix

Each framework is scored on a 1–5 scale (1 = Poor fit, 2 = Below average, 3 = Adequate, 4 = Strong, 5 = Excellent) against each weighted criterion. The weighted total determines overall fit for Rackspace Technology.

TABLE 4.1: FRAMEWORK SCORING MATRIX — WEIGHTED FOR RACKSPACE TECHNOLOGY

| Framework | AI/ML (25%) | Cul-ture (20%) | Value (15%) | Bench-mark (10%) | Self-Assess (10%) | Com-pre-hensive (10%) | AI Gov (10%) | Weight-ed Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| DAMA DMBOK2 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 5 | 2 | **1.65** |
| EDMC DCAM | 1 | 1 | 1 | 4 | 1 | 4 | 3 | **1.85** |
| TDWI | 2 | 2 | 2 | 4 | 5 | 3 | 2 | **2.65** |
| Gartner D&A | 4 | 3 | 3 | 4 | 2 | 4 | 3 | **3.35** |
| CMMI DMM | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 3 | 3 | 2 | **1.60** |
| CDAMM (Laney) | 4 | 4 | 4 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 3 | **3.90** |
| VECTR (Karan) | 3 | 5 | 4 | 2 | 5 | 3 | 2 | **3.55** |

# 5 The Recommendation

## 5.1 Primary Framework: CDAMM (Laney's Comprehensive D&A Maturity Model)

CDAMM is the only framework in this set that operates across the full spectrum — from the technical plumbing (architecture, integration, technology operations) through the organizational muscle (skills, governance, quality) all the way up to the strategic and cultural dimensions (strategy, leadership, metrics, deployment) — while simultaneously incorporating AI as a native element at every level rather than treating it as a bolt-on afterthought. The 200+ indicators across 8 dimensions with 5 maturity levels give enough granularity to identify *specific* gaps rather than just painting a broad picture.

For Rackspace specifically, three factors make CDAMM the right primary choice.

1. The **Deployment & Usage** dimension explicitly measures whether analytics and AI capabilities are being monetized externally — which is literally Rackspace's strategic bet.
2. The **Culture & Leadership** dimension captures whether executives champion data practices and whether data democratization exists throughout the organization, which addresses the likely gap between what Rackspace sells and how it operates internally.
3. The **secondary attributes** (Collaboration, Communication, Innovation, Value, Implementation) provide the cross-cutting diagnostic that a technology company in transformation needs — they tell you not just *what* your capabilities are but *how effectively the organization executes* against them.

## 5.2 Complementary Framework: VECTR (Coach Karan's Data Culture Framework)

The VECTR framework should be deployed alongside CDAMM as a culture-specific deep dive. CDAMM gives you Culture & Leadership as one of eight dimensions. VECTR makes it five dedicated pillars with 20 competencies, each with four measurable levels. For a company where the probable maturity gap lives disproportionately in the cultural and behavioral space — where the technology exists but the internal data-driven decision-making culture likely lags — VECTR gives the resolution that CDAMM's single culture dimension cannot.

The Decision Traceability pillar is particularly relevant for Rackspace. As a company that manages customer infrastructure, the ability to trace decisions back through data to business outcomes is not just nice-to-have — it is what their customers are buying. If Rackspace cannot demonstrate decision traceability internally, the credibility of selling it externally erodes.

## 5.3 What to Skip and Why

**DAMA DMBOK2 and CMMI DMM**

Too technical, no AI coverage, no value or culture lens. These are fine frameworks for organizations whose primary challenge is basic data management hygiene. Rackspace is past that.

**EDMC DCAM**

Designed for financial services regulatory environments. The certified assessor requirement and financial-sector orientation make it the wrong tool for a technology services company. No AI coverage in 2026 is disqualifying.

**TDWI**

The best of the also-rans because it is free, benchmarkable, and accessible. Worth running as a quick baseline if budget is constrained, but it lacks the strategic depth of CDAMM.

**Gartner D&A**

Would be the primary recommendation if Rackspace already has a Gartner advisory relationship, because the peer comparison and tracking data is excellent. But it is locked behind the paywall, executive-only in orientation, and less comprehensive than CDAMM on the technical dimensions that matter for a cloud infrastructure company.

## 5.4 Conditional Exception

If Rackspace already pays for Gartner advisory services, the Gartner D&A Maturity Score becomes more competitive because the peer benchmarking against other cloud and technology companies would give the executive team the comparative context that CDAMM alone cannot provide. In that scenario, the recommendation shifts to Gartner D&A as the primary institutional framework with VECTR as the culture overlay, using CDAMM's dimension structure as the internal roadmap template.

# 6 Deployment Approach

The following phased approach is recommended for deploying the selected frameworks at Rackspace Technology.

PROCEDURE 6.1: RECOMMENDED ASSESSMENT DEPLOYMENT

1. **Phase 1: CDAMM Enterprise Assessment (Weeks 1–4)**
   Run the CDAMM assessment across business units using the self-assessment methodology. Score all 8 dimensions. Use the juxtaposition approach from the CMU course materials — compare how knowledge workers versus management perceive maturity, and how business units score against each other. The gaps between those views will be more diagnostic than the absolute scores.

2. **Phase 2: VECTR Culture Deep Dive (Weeks 3–6, overlapping)**
   Deploy VECTR specifically to the executive team and their direct reports. The Leadership Vision and Executive Ownership pillars will reveal whether the C-suite's AI ambitions (which are very public and very loud) are matched by the organizational behaviors that actually produce data-driven outcomes.

3. **Phase 3: Synthesis and Strategic Mapping (Weeks 7–8)**
   Synthesize findings into a combined maturity profile. Map CDAMM dimension scores against Rackspace's strategic priorities — AI Business platform success, Palantir partnership execution, FAIR practice scaling — and identify which maturity gaps create the highest risk to those specific revenue-generating initiatives.

# A Sources

## A1 Course Materials


- Laney, Douglas B. *CDAIO Module 3: Data and Analytics (and AI) Maturity*. Carnegie Mellon University Heinz College, Chief Data and AI Officer Program. 06-Feb-2026.
- Coach Karan. *Data Culture Presentation*. 09-Feb-2026.


## A2 Rackspace Technology Public Intelligence


- Rackspace Technology 2025 State of Cloud Report (https://www.rackspace.com/newsroom/new-research-rackspace-technology-2025-state-cloud-report)
- Rackspace AI Business Platform Launch (March 2025) (https://www.rackspace.com/newsroom/rackspace-technology-announces-rackspace-ai-business)
- Rackspace 2025 AI Research Report — The AI Acceleration Gap (https://www.rackspace.com/newsroom/rackspace-reveals-2025-ai-report)
- FAIR 2024 AI Research Report (https://www.rackspace.com/newsroom/foundry-ai-rackspace-fair-2024-ai-research-report)
- Rackspace Cloud Modernization Survey (https://www.rackspace.com/newsroom/rackspace-technology-cloud-modernization-survey)
- Rackspace Investor Relations — Press Releases (https://ir.rackspace.com/news-and-events/press-releases/)